



DEVELOPING ANDROID WEBAPPS USING HTML5 TECHNOLOGIES

WebApps are easy to develop and with them, it is actually possible to 'write once, and deploy everywhere'.

Anyone who has used Gmail or the likes knows what a WebApp is. It is a browser-based application served over the Internet (or any other network). One difference between a Web page and a WebApp is that the latter, typically has more interactive options like buttons, icons and alerts, like a regular application. While the initial versions of WebApps needed an always-on Internet connection, the latest WebApps can be used just like native apps, with limited or no Internet connection. Some examples of the best WebApp alternatives to native apps are from Google, Facebook, Twitter, Citibank, Financial Times and paytm.com.

A blessing to WebApp developers is 'WebKit', the layout engine common to Android and Apple Safari browsers. This makes a WebApp available to a wide range of mobile devices in the market.

The WebApps trend

Web 2.0 technologies made the power of native desktop applications available to browser-based WebApps. Google Docs, for example, gives users almost the same functionality as desktop-based office suites. It is a no-brainer to predict the same trend on mobile devices. In fact, according to experts, what took three decades to mature on PCs will happen in the next five years on mobile devices.

The convergence of three important trends is key to the evolution of WebApps on mobiles. While better-performing smartphones favour both native apps and WebApps equally, the declining tariffs of mobile data services and the standardisation of improved Open Web technologies favour WebApps.